

PREMIUM GUIDE

CARNEGIE MELLON UNIVERSITY

# Complete Admission Guide for Indian Students

Programs, Fees, Scholarships, Placements & Campus Life

Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania



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# 1. Carnegie Mellon University at a Glance

|                   |                 |                    |                           |                       |
|-------------------|-----------------|--------------------|---------------------------|-----------------------|
| #51<br>QS RANKING | 1900<br>FOUNDED | 15,000<br>STUDENTS | 1,200+<br>INDIAN STUDENTS | 97%<br>PLACEMENT RATE |
|-------------------|-----------------|--------------------|---------------------------|-----------------------|

| Attribute              | Details                                        |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Full Name              | Carnegie Mellon University                     |
| Location               | Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania, USA                  |
| Type                   | Private (Est. 1900)                            |
| Acceptance Rate        | 11%                                            |
| Student-Faculty Ratio  | 10:1                                           |
| Graduation Rate        | 93%                                            |
| International Students | 35%                                            |
| Gender Ratio           | 45:55 (F:M)                                    |
| Website                | cmu.edu                                        |
| Motto                  | The World's #1 for Computer Science & Robotics |

Carnegie Mellon University is a private research university in Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania. CMU's School of Computer Science is ranked #1 globally, and its robotics, AI, and machine learning programs are legendary. With strong industry ties to Google, Uber, and Amazon, CMU is a top choice for Indian tech students.

## Notable Alumni

- Andy Bechtolsheim — Co-founder of Sun Microsystems
- John Nash — Nobel Prize in Economics (A Beautiful Mind)

## 2. Why Choose Carnegie?

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- CMU CS is ranked #1 in the world (tied with MIT/Stanford)
- 1,200+ Indian students — strong South Asian community
- CMU Robotics Institute is the world's largest robotics research centre
- Average CS salary: \$160,000+ — among the highest globally
- Direct recruiting from Google, Uber, Amazon, and Microsoft
- CMU's Entertainment Technology Center created the first Oscar-winning digital character

### | Academic Environment

The most technically rigorous university in the world. CMU's CS curriculum is legendary for its difficulty. Everyone here is brilliant and competitive. The workload is intense but the outcomes are unmatched. Research is world-leading.

### | Student Life

Pittsburgh is an affordable, friendly city. The cost of living is incredibly low for a top-tier university. Squirrel Hill has a strong Jewish and Indian community. The social scene is more about tech events and hackathons than parties.

# 3. Programs & Courses

## Popular Programs for Indian Students

| Program                                    | Level | Duration | Tuition      | Highlights                                                |
|--------------------------------------------|-------|----------|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| MS in Computer Science                     | PG    | 2 Years  | \$55K-58K/yr | The world's #1 CS program. AI, ML, robotics, and systems. |
| MS in Robotics                             | PG    | 2 Years  | \$55K-58K/yr | The world's first and largest robotics master's program.  |
| MS in Artificial Intelligence & Innovation | PG    | 1 Year   | \$55K-58K/yr | AI product development and entrepreneurship.              |

# 4. Eligibility & Requirements

## Admission Requirements

| Requirement     | Details                               |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------|
| GPA             | 8.5+ (Outstanding)                    |
| GRE             | 330+                                  |
| IELTS           | 7.5+                                  |
| TOEFL           | 110+                                  |
| Work Experience | Not required                          |
| LORs            | 3 LORs (at least 1 from research)     |
| SOP             | Required (with research interests)    |
| Resume          | Required (with publications/projects) |
| Interview       | Some programs                         |
| Application Fee | \$75                                  |

# 5. Application Deadlines

| Intake     | Deadline | Decision Date |
|------------|----------|---------------|
| Fall (Aug) | Dec 1    | Mar 1         |



# 6. Tuition & Cost of Living

| Expense Category | Cost               |
|------------------|--------------------|
| Tuition (MS)     | \$55,000-58,000/yr |
| Accommodation    | \$10,000-15,000/yr |
| Food             | \$4,000-6,000/yr   |
| Transport        | \$1,000/yr         |
| Health Insurance | \$3,000/yr         |
| Personal         | \$3,000-5,000/yr   |

## 7. Scholarships & Funding

| Scholarship                                  | Amount                             | Eligibility                 | Deadline        |
|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|-----------------------------|-----------------|
| <b>CMU Presidential Fellowship</b>           | Full tuition + \$35,000/yr stipend | Top 2% of admitted students | Auto-considered |
| <b>Tata Consultancy Services Scholarship</b> | \$20,000-40,000/yr                 | Indian students in CS/IT    | Dec 1           |

# 8. Placements & Career Outcomes

|                                          |                                            |                                                |                                      |
|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| <div>97%</div> <div>PLACEMENT RATE</div> | <div>\$160,000</div> <div>AVG SALARY</div> | <div>\$350,000</div> <div>HIGHEST SALARY</div> | <div>700+</div> <div>COMPANIES</div> |
|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|

## Post-Study Work Pathway

OPT → H-1B → Green Card | Work visa duration: 3 years (STEM OPT)

## 9. Campus Life for Indians

| Aspect                    | Details                                                            |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Indian Association</b> | CMU South Asian Students Association — 300+ members                |
| <b>Accommodation</b>      | On-campus housing (guaranteed 1st year) + Pittsburgh apartments    |
| <b>Avg Rent</b>           | \$800-1,200/month (affordable!)                                    |
| <b>Indian Food</b>        | India Garden, Tamarind, multiple Indian groceries in Squirrel Hill |
| <b>Weather</b>            | Cold winters (-5°C), warm summers (28°C). Four distinct seasons.   |
| <b>Transport</b>          | Free campus shuttle + Pittsburgh bus system                        |
| <b>Healthcare</b>         | University Health Services                                         |
| <b>Safety</b>             | Safe. Campus police 24/7.                                          |

### Nightlife & Social Scene

Squirrel Hill bars. Oakland for student nightlife. Pittsburgh has a surprisingly good food and bar scene. House parties are common.

### Student Clubs & Societies

- **CMU SASA** — Cultural
- **CMU Bhangra** — Dance
- **Robotics Club** — Tech
- **AI Society** — Tech
- **ScottyLabs** — Entrepreneurship
- **Game Creation Society** — Creative
- **Outdoors Club** — Outdoor
- **Chess Club** — Gaming

## 11. What Students Say

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*"CMU CS broke me and rebuilt me as an engineer. \$160K at Google straight out of graduation."*

— **Vikram, MS CS '24**

*"The Robotics Institute is a dream. I'm working on self-driving cars with Uber's research team."*

— **Sneha, MS Robotics '25**

*"Pittsburgh is so affordable. I pay \$800 for a 2-bedroom apartment. That's unheard of for a top-10 uni."*

— **Rohan, MS AI '24**

# Your Carnegie Journey Starts Here

Get expert guidance on your Carnegie Mellon University application —  
SOP review, LOR templates, visa prep, and more.

[www.kohortconnect.com](http://www.kohortconnect.com)

